ACTIVITY 3

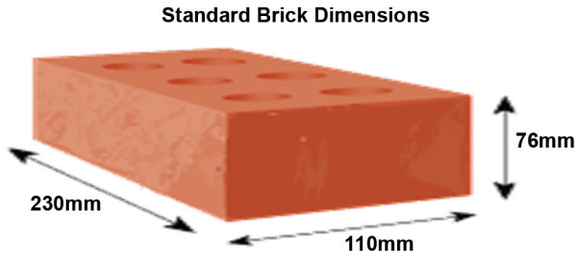
Collect the photos of ancient brick buildings and modern brick buildings and make an album.

3.2.3 Size and Weight of Brick

The Bricks are prepared in various sizes. The custom in the locality is the governing factor to decide the size of brick. Such bricks which are not standardised are known as traditional bricks.

BIS has recommended the bricks of uniform size. Such bricks are known as Modular bricks. The actual size of modular bricks is 190mm × 90mm × 90mm. With mortar thickness (10mm) the nominal size of modular brick is 200mm × 100mm × 100mm.

But practically to match with the beam width, a brick or block of width 230mm is used widely in construction industry. 115 mm is considered for half brick. The brick of size 230 mm × 110mm × 110 mm or 230mm × 110mm × 76mm is generally used in construction industry.



It is found that the weight of 1m^3 of brick earth is about 1800 kg. Hence the average weight of brick will be about 3.0 to 3.5 kg.

The size of Indian brick we are using is 228mm × 107mm × 69mm.

3.2.4 Brick Earth

Bricks are easily moulded from plastic clays also known as brick clay or brick earth.



Composition of Good Brick Earth

According to IS 2119-1975 the clay or mixture of clay selected should preferably confirm the following composition.

Clay = 20 – 30% by weight
Silt = 20 – 35% by weight
Sand= 35 – 50% by weight

Constituents of Brick Earth

Following are the constituent of good brick earth.

i) Alumina :

It is the chief constituent of clay. A good brick earth should contain 20 to 30% of alumina. This constituent imparts plasticity to earth. So that it can be moulded easily. If alumina is present in excess, raw bricks shrink and warp during drying and burning.

Civil_English_Unit_3.indd 64 12/21/2019 2:26:05 PM